Solar System Notes

The Solar System formed about 4.6 billion years ago. It consists of the Sun and eight planets. Mercury is the closest planet to the Sun and the smallest planet.

Venus is the hottest planet, with a surface temperature of about 465 degrees Celsius, because its thick carbon dioxide atmosphere traps heat.

Earth is the third planet from the Sun and the only place in the universe known to support life. Mars has two small moons, Phobos and Deimos.

Jupiter is the largest planet in the Solar System, and its mass is more than twice that of all the other planets combined.

Saturn is famous for its extensive ring system, which is made mostly of ice particles. Uranus rotates on its side. Neptune is the farthest planet from the Sun.

Light from the Sun takes about eight minutes and twenty seconds to reach Earth.